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# Trisha B. Thomas, Ph.D.

## AI & UX Researcher | Learning Scientist | Cognitive Neuroscientist

### PROFILE

UX researcher with a background in cognitive neuroscience and AI-enhanced educational technology, specializing in human-computer interaction, user-centered design, and multilingual learning environments. Experienced in designing and running user studies across diverse populations, including children and multilingual users. Skilled in mixed-methods research, behavioral data analysis (Python, R), and applying neurocognitive tools (EEG, fNIRS) to study engagement, usability, and learning. Proven success in interdisciplinary, cross-cultural collaborations that inform inclusive and equitable product design.

### EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

**UX Researcher – Self Employed** **2025 – Present**

*Notable Client: Ipsos North America*

*Visiting Researcher: University of Modena and Reggio Emilia (July 2026 – Present)*

- Supporting UX research initiatives as a contract researcher, focusing on study design, participant engagement, and delivering actionable insights.

**Harvard University Graduate School of Education & University of Michigan** **2023 – 2025**

*Postdoctoral Research Fellow (Oct 2023 – Aug 2025); Visiting Scholar (Aug 2025 – Aug 2026), Child Centered AI Lab*

- Conducted research on child-AI interaction & education across both institutions, following the relocation of the lab from UM to Harvard
- Analyzed behavioral and fNIRS data to investigate how children perceive and interact with AI enabled educational tools, using Python and R for statistical analysis and data visualization
- Led user experience studies with multilingual child participants, providing data-driven recommendations for optimizing AI-enabled learning interventions

**University of California, Irvine** **2021 – 2025**

*Visiting Scholar, Digital Learning Lab*

- Collaborated on the "Converse to Learn" project, combining automatic speech recognition and intent classification to study children's science learning from interactive educational programs
- Collected data from over 200 elementary school students, conducting assessments of bilingual language development

**Basque Center on Cognition, Brain, and Language** **2019 – 2023**

*Graduate Research Assistant*

- Designed and conducted EEG experiments on bilingual language processing, focusing on the effects of accented speech on cognitive processing
- Published research findings in peer-reviewed journals and presented at international conferences

### EDUCATION

**Ph.D. in Cognitive Neuroscience** *Basque Center on Cognition, Brain, and Language | University of the Basque Country, Spain. Summa Cum Laude.*

**Master in Cognitive Neuroscience of Language** *University of the Basque Country, Spain.*

**Bachelor of Arts in Cognitive Science, Concentration: Language & Linguistics** *Indiana University Bloomington, USA. Honors.*

### SKILLS

Programming, Analysis, & Visualization: Python, R, MATLAB, SPSS, MNE Python, Excel
Research Methods: Usability testing, user interviews, survey design, mixed-methods analysis, remote studies, EEG/ERP, fNIRS, frequency band analysis, qualitative, quantitative
Tools: Figma, Gorilla, Qualtrics, PRAAT, Audacity, Goldwave, Git, Psychopy, LLMs (e.g., ChatGPT/OpenAI)
Languages: English (Native), Spanish (Advanced), Mandarin (A2-B1)